الطالب الأكاديمي
THE ACADEMIC STUDENT

Faculty of Business Studies

BUS629

INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS

Final Examination/ Form B

2025-2026 / Fall

15 – January – 2026

r of Exam Pages: 3 ing this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 3 hours

ONS:

VE (5) minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
hones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF"** mode throughout the examination.
CLOSED book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
ST answer the questions using only the answer booklets provided
ST return the examination paper together with your answer booklets.
write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
re **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examinati
re allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

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YOU HAVE TO ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS IN ESSAY FORMAT. EACH QUESTION CARRIES 25 MARKS

Question 1- Case Study

FashionForward is a well-known company that sells high-end clothes and accessories. Now, they want to sell their products in Asia, especially in China, Japan, and India. The company plans to use a mix of standardizing some products and adapting others to meet the needs of local markets. For example, they may keep the same designs for some items but change colors or sizes based on local preferences. However, they face challenges in hiring and managing the right employees to run their business in these new countries. FashionForward must think carefully about how to position their brand in each market. This means understanding what makes their brand special and how it can appeal to people in China, Japan, and India. They also need to decide how to recruit and manage staff for their new offices, considering the cultural differences in each country.

Question 1(A):

As FashionForward expands into China, Japan, and India, explain how the company should develop its product and promotional strategies to succeed in these markets. In your answer, discuss how laws, culture, brand names, and other product issues may influence decisions. (25 marks)

Answer Guidelines & Marks:

To answer this question effectively you should explain how FashionForward can develop product strategies that consider laws, culture, and the selection of suitable brand and product names (10 marks). You should also discuss how the company can create effective promotional strategies, including the use of push and pull approaches, international advertising etc. for different markets (13 marks). Finally, the response should be well-structured, logical, and relevant to the case scenario to earn 2 marks for structure. Total: 25 marks

Question 1 (B): Given the cultural diversity of the Asian markets, what staffing policy should FashionForward implement? Compare the pros and cons of ethnocentric, polycentric, and geocentric staffing approaches. (25 marks)

Answer Guidelines & Marks:

To answer this question effectively: Explain the staffing policy FashionForward should use (8 marks). Compare and contrast the ethnocentric, polycentric, and geocentric staffing approaches (15 marks). Explain the advantages and disadvantages of each approach. Ensure the response is

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well-organized, clearly comparing the three staffing approaches, and relevant to the scenario to earn (2 marks) for structure. Total: 25 marks

Question 2: An automotive company is entering a foreign market and must weigh the benefits of forming a joint venture with a local partner versus establishing a wholly owned subsidiary to maintain control. **How does joint venture differ from wholly owned subsidiary as a contractual entry mode. What factors should a company consider when choosing between a joint venture and a wholly owned subsidiary for entering a foreign market? (25 marks)**

Answer Guidelines and Marks:

To answer effectively: Discuss the difference between Joint venture and wholly owned subsidiary as entry modes (10 marks). Discuss the factors a company should consider when choosing between these options (13 marks). Ensure the response is concise, logically organized, and directly addresses the scenario to earn 2 marks for structure. Total: 25 marks.

Question 3: In any research process, choosing the right method is essential. Both secondary and primary market research have unique roles to play in analyzing international opportunities. **Compare and contrast secondary market research and primary market research methods. Discuss the types of public and private information sources available for secondary research and the challenges businesses face with both types of research. (25 marks)**

Answer Guidelines and Marks:

To answer effectively compare the difference between secondary market research and primary market research methods. (8 marks). Discuss the types of public and private information sources available for secondary research (10 marks) and identify and list at least few challenges businesses face with both types of research. (5 marks). Ensure the response is concise, logically reasoned, and directly addresses the scenario to earn 2 marks for structure. Total: 25 marks

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END OF EXAM

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